fourth Test in Centurion to do something special. That's the way past players like Kallis and Smith did it; they had tough times as well but they fought back and found a way to get back to the top.'

We did respond well in the fourth and last Test, with Stephen Cook, Hashim and Quinton all scoring centuries in our first-innings score of 475. Stephen had been brought into the team as a specialist opening batsman and, while everybody knew he was the son of Jimmy Cook, a great player of the 1980s and 1990s, he quickly made a name for himself by showing a great attitude and great skill in joining the select group of players to score a century on his Test debut. KG took seven wickets as we dismissed England for 342, before Hashim and Temba made runs, putting us in position to declare, setting the tourists an unlikely target of 382 to win.

I was enjoying the captaincy and most of our plans were working, but I was also setting the wrong kind of records with the bat. Following my duck in the second innings at the Wanderers, I had been caught in the slips for 0 in our first innings, and was trapped LBW for 0 by Anderson in our second innings. Three consecutive ducks were unwelcome, but the team was playing well and that's what mattered.

England were dismissed for 101, and we won the Test match by 280 runs. KG had run in again and claimed another six wickets. His match figures of 13 wickets for 144 confirmed his arrival as a top-class fast bowler; it is exciting to imagine what he might achieve in years to come because I know he will work hard and learn fast.

Our revival continued during the limited-over matches that followed. We staged a fine comeback to win the ODI series 3–2 after losing the first and second games, and we then won both T20 internationals. I was pleased to score an unbeaten 101 in our successful chase to win the decisive one-day international and, although the disappointment of losing the Test series lingered, we had regrouped and recovered well from the catastrophic afternoon at the Wanderers. It was good to see the players smiling again.